

Motorola Bets on Pure Android for its Smartphones

Motorola recently launched the Moto E smartphone, which has received a tremendous positive response in the market. The smartphone went out of stock in less than 24 hours after it was launched exclusively on the e-commerce portal Flipkart. **Prasid Banerjee** from **Open Source For You**, who was at the launch, had a chat with **Punit Soni, vice president, Product Management for Motorola**, about the company's open source strategy.



Punit Soni, vice president, Product Management for Motorola

Motorola has taken the smartphone universe by storm with three of its most recently launched smartphones—the Moto X, Moto G and Moto E. The company has been following a combination of running pure Android along with state-of-the-art engineering to bring out devices that are cheap, yet powerful, and high on features compared to their competitors. But Motorola has repeatedly refused to do its own customisation to the Android OS, maintaining that pure Android is the best way to go. So does this mean Motorola has no open source aspirations of its own? Apparently not.

Motorola and openness

According to Soni, “I think, in general, being open is better. Opening our platform so that people can take advantage of it

is better and it's in line with our overall strategy. We haven't done it yet because we're still building ourselves up.”

Soni explained that for things like touchless control and active notifications (both defining features of the company's flagship Moto X smartphone), it is better to get developers involved. But the company's focus right now is to deliver a good product rather than sell it in large numbers. So while the company is considering the option of going open, it doesn't think that this is the right time to do so. Soni did not, however, rule out the possibility of Motorola launching its own open source initiatives in the future.

Knowing Motorola, the chances of this happening could be high, considering that the company's Rhomobile Suite for enterprise mobility is pretty well known. This is an application development platform that allows you to build applications that run on all kinds of devices, irrespective of the type of the device, its screen size or what operating system it runs on. Not only does it help with developing apps for use within the enterprise, but also addresses a wider user base. The company already enjoys partnerships with big names like Cognizant, Cell Software, Tata Consultancy Services, and many others. Motorola also has the Mx suite of enterprise features and the Enterprise Development Kit (EMDK) for Android, which are available to the developer community.

Connecting with developers

Motorola has already announced the dates for its AppForum event for this year. The event is into its fifth edition and hosts three days of developer-oriented activities for those developing apps for the enterprise segment. A free-to-attend technical seminar will be held in the United Kingdom in July, apart from monthly webinars for developers, where experts from Motorola Solutions discuss various relevant topics to help developers in their work.

It is evident that the company has a number of developer initiatives. Unlike other original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), Motorola currently doesn't have its own platform. But Soni said that while layering on Android and adding UIs was pretty useless, Motorola would, sometime in the future (subject to conditions), consider developing its own platform.

Right now, Motorola is focusing on delivering good products at a more than affordable price. The company made a killing in both foreign and domestic markets with the Moto G,